The Princess & the Magicat

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The Princess & the Magicat

by AstrynSerene

Summary

Princess Glimmer was raised in a world of riches.

Catra was raised in a world of rags.

With Brightmoon slowly falling to ruin, Queen Angella sees little other option when she discovers the wealthy Princess Adora of Eternia is seeking a bride. Glimmer hesitantly goes along with it to save her kingdom, but her heart secretly lies with her lifelong best friend and tutor, Bow.

Meanwhile in the village, Catra is a struggling seamstress trying to work off the debt of her late parents, an indentured servant to her wicked employer, Shadow Weaver. She's not sure what she would do without her best friends, Scorpia and Melog. She hopes to one day make a simple life of her own with her friends.

Unsurprisingly, these girls have never met, at least until Fate decreed they would.

Notes

A little bit of information about this universe!

Glimmer can preform magical illusions, but she cannot teleport. If you know the original story, you'll understand why I did that, haha.

Scorpia does have pincers, so I'm guessing she has some kind of special equipment to help her with sewing? I've written the entire fic already outside of the epilogue and she's only mentioned sewing a couple of times, but I'm never really specific about how she does it. 😅

There are some darker themes mentioned in this fic, which is why I chose the warning I did. I will ofc put trigger warnings at the start of chapters! ❤️

Chapter 1: The Princess

Long ago, and far away, in the kingdom of Brightmoon, the beloved rulers, King Micah and Queen Angella gave birth to a beautiful baby girl. It was a planet wide celebration, as the couple had been trying for a baby for years, and after many failed conceptions had finally been able to fulfill their dream.

Princess Glimmer was given only the finest of life's luxuries from the moment she was born, seen as a miracle baby and beloved by everyone who saw her. She was blessed with a perfect childhood of lace and ball gowns, tutors and close friends and parents who loved her, that spent every free moment with her.

Unfortunately, when she was seven, her father's life was taken during a diplomatic mission to the Crimson Waste; the loss was great on not just the family, but the kingdom as well. Glimmer noticed how her mother became reserved, focusing more on work and began to see her less than less. On top of that, the kingdom had fallen into a financial crisis, and a solution seemed far from reach.

The depression caused the queen to lean more and more on her very trusted Royal Advisor, Horde Prime. While Glimmer despised him, he'd done well to help keep Brightmoon from ruin, at least for the last few years. Now though, just a week after her eighteenth birthday, Prime was away on some journey, and her mother was desperate.

That's when Eternia became the topic of a miracle. It was the largest kingdom on Etheria, taking up land in the plains behind Plumeria and the entirety of the Whispering Woods. More importantly though, they were the wealthiest, and unfortunately for Glimmer, their princess was seeking a wife.

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Glimmer groaned as she burst through the library doors, slamming them behind her and collapsing on the nearest couch.

"Isn't that your wedding dress?" She heard Bow ask, her tutor (and lifelong best friend), who hadn't even bothered to look up from his desk.

"...yes." the princess grumbled. Finally, Bow looked up at her.

"It looks beautiful! Needs a few alterations to fit right but- you look great!" He complimented, offering a thumbs up and crooked smile.

"Probably because I walked out of my fitting."

"Why? You know you're just gonna be dragged back sooner or later."

"I know! I just- I needed like two seconds of peace where I'm not being told 'You gotta be at this meeting! Oh princess, you got a new present for an engagement you don't wanna be in! Oh by the way, you have another history lesson too!' Ugh!"

"I thought you liked my history lessons?" Bow pouted, but Glimmer could practically see the teasing undertone in his words.

"That's- you know what I mean, Bow." Sighing, the pinkette finally got to her feet and crossed the room to stand next to her tutor, "What are you doing in here anyway?"

"Well, I don't know if you remember but- we had a history lesson today." He replied, his smirk not wavering when he was playfully wacked on the arm.

"That's not funny." Glimmer pouted, crossing her arms.

"Really? I thought it was hilarious."

"Ha ha. So, since we're on said topic, what are you gonna talk about today, *tutor* ?"

"Well, I figured since this whole wedding thing is in like a week and the ambassador is coming in a couple of days," Bow felt Glimmer's frown before he looked up from his notes to face her again, "I thought that maybe we could have a hands on lesson today, and go on a carriage ride to Brightmoon for a little tour."

Glimmer gasped, her eyes literally sparkling, "Really?!"

"I mean- if you're up for it." Bow shrugged, before giving a sly smirk, "Unless you'd rather just stay here and go over Plumerian customs again-"

"-NO!" Glimmer threw her arms around him, hugging him tight, "Oh thank you, thank you, thank you!" She squealed, "When do we leave?!"

"I think we can head out after you get through that fitting and change into something less-princessy?" He chuckled.

"Okay!" Giggling, she kissed him on the cheek before rushing to the door as quickly as she could in a three layer wedding dress, "I love you! You are officially the bestest friend EVER!" She called before closing the door behind her.

"Hehe, yeah.. friend.." Now that he was alone, Bow finally allowed himself to frown and let the emotions he'd pushed down bubble to the surface.

Ever since the engagement with the Princesses of Eternia and Brightmoon had been announced, he hadn't been able to think about Eternia without tears threatening to surface or grinding his teeth with rage. When they were kids, Queen Angella and King Micah had graciously allowed him to study in the castle library with his fathers, and befriend the princess in the process.

Over the years, he'd slowly fallen in love with her, and dreamed of the day he could be of a status good enough to marry her. Of course, that would never be more than a fantasy. He was a commoner, a nobody that was just lucky and smart enough to tutor the princess. Now that this alliance was needed, all he could do was stand on the sidelines and be moral support for his unrequited love.

Besides, she clearly didn't feel the same way. She made it painfully clear to him that they were best friends, and nothing more.

Taking a deep breath, he gathered his things and shoved them into his satchel, standing from his desk. He had a field trip to prepare for, and a very limited space of time to make it happen. He knew once Prime returned that evening and the ambassador arrived, Glimmer would have zero time or chance for a moment of freedom.

He would make these next few hours the best of her life, no matter what. Social statuses be damned, she would have at least a second to experience freedom, as much as he could give her. He may never be her husband, but he could at least be the best friend she needed.

Chapter 2: The Magicat

Chapter Summary

(Another little introductory chapter before the real fun begins)

Catra relies on nobody but herself. And maybe Scorpia and Melog, just a little. They're the only ones she feels she can trust, or will ever trust.

Catra didn't have much that she was thankful for in her life, and she had very little to look forward to. She was born to two very loving mothers, but unlike the Princess of Brightmoon whom she shared a birthday with, her parents had been far less wealthy. In fact, they'd been downright poor, living in a tiny cottage with barely enough to feed each other, let alone a kitten. Because of this, they'd been forced to take a loan from a shady seamstress that had employed them for years.

Even worse, when Catra was only a few years old, one of her mothers fell violently ill, while the other was murdered while out one night running errands. It was one devastating heartbreak after another, and soon the kitten was left with the massive debts her parents left behind.

With nowhere to go and no way to survive, Catra was forced to grow up an indentured servant under Shadow Weaver as her seamstress, tirelessly working in hopes of one day paying off her family debts and gaining the freedom to travel the world and make a life for herself.

Currently, that meant sewing up gown after gown for all the nobles who were planning to attend the upcoming wedding of the Princesses' Eternia and Brightmoon. She scoffed at the thought of royalty, furrowing her eyebrows as she threaded a needle through fabric, sewing a sleeve to its matching dress that she'd been slaving over since last night.

"You're rage sewing again, Wildcat."

"And I still don't know what that means." Catra replied, pausing for a moment to look up at Scorpia, the other seamstress underneath Shadow Weaver, and Catra's only friend aside from her alien companion, Melog, part feline much like herself.

"It means exactly what it says," Scorpia chuckled, "Angry sewing that leads to pricks and swearing."

"Ah, or as Shadow Weaver would say, *very unladylike* !" She smirked, a mocking tone taking over at the mention of her 'employer'.

"It *is* unladylike to swear like a sailor, Catra."

Both women froze, tensing as the chilling voice pierced their ears, footsteps all too familiar descending the stairs, "And from what I'm looking at, you'll be at this all day for two dresses. Keep this up and you'll be at this longer than just the thirty seven years you already owe me, Catra."

"What?!" The brunette snapped, pupils shrinking as she glared at the older woman, "Thirty seven?! I've already paid back sixty percent, maybe more!"

"Ah, so you think." Shadow Weaver hummed, placing a hand on her shoulder and squeezing. Melog hissed at the sight they all knew was an exertion of power over them, "But you forget about the interest that's built up. Of course, you've never stepped into a schoolhouse so, it's not that you would know how simple math works."

Growling, Catra had to bite back every instinct in her body that made her want to maul this woman alive, "I may not have been able to go to school, but I know how much I've paid you, and I don't have thirty seven years of work left that I owe you. Five, ten *maybe* if you-"

"-Do NOT backsass me, you brat!" Shadow Weaver suddenly snapped, grabbing Catra by her chin and forcing eye contact. Scorpia had to force herself not to sting the witch while simultaneously holding Melog back as well, "I have raised you and given you a roof and food since you were four; how *dare* you disrespect me! You belong to *me* , until every penny those whores you called mothers borrowed is returned to my pocket. If you are ever so lucky as to

do so, *then* you will be free to try and make something of your pathetic existence. As of now, you are *my property* , and you will do as I say and keep that dangerous mouth of yours closed before I whip you and remove your tongue, *do you understand* ?!"

Trembling slightly, Catra could only nod, feeling disgusted at the triumph in Shadow Weaver's smirk as she finally let her go and made her way back up the stairs, "Oh, and ladies, those orders better be finished by Friday." She added casually before exiting and slamming the door behind her.

"Wildcat..?" Scorpia started after a moment, flinching when her friend broke down, slamming a fist into the table as tears ran down her face. Her heart shattered at the sight. It was so rare for Catra to just break like this, normally so determined and upbeat about finally finishing her servitude, "Oh, Wildcat.. come here…"

Letting the dress fall from her lap to the floor, Catra slowly rose from her seat and walked into Scorpia's waiting arms, "It's not fair..!" She whimpered, burying her face into her friend's shoulder, her body relaxing slightly when she felt Scorpia's pincer gently rubbing her back, "I'm t-trying so hard..!"

"I know, I know… you'll get there, *we'll* get you there. I promise.."

"She'll never let me! S-She *hates* me but she won't just let me leave! She gets pleasure from t-torturing me!" Openly sobbing now, the magicat let it all out in her friend's arms for nearly ten minutes before she was reduced to whimpers and sniffles.

Until she felt Catra was ready, Scorpia simply stood there, cradling her best friend against her, whispering assurances in her ear. Once she seemed calmer, Scorpia pulled back a little to face her, "Hey, Wildcat?"

"Mhm..?"

"It's been a long day for you. Why don't you and Melog go for a walk in the village, and I'll keep things going here."

"Oh, Scorpia that's sweet, but I couldn't just-"

"-I *insist* . You need fresh air. I bet you couldn't tell me the last time you left for anything that wasn't a fabric or thread run."

"I…mm.."

"Exactly. Now go; Shadow Weaver won't come back for a day, maybe two. You'll be okay."

Finally smiling, Catra nodded, throwing her arms around Scorpia's shoulders, "Thank you..!"

"Of course. Don't forget your cape," She reminded, gently wiping her friend's tears before letting her go.

Nodding, Catra hurried over and slipped on her flats and clipped her cloak around her shoulders, pulling her hood up, "Melog!" She whistled, smiling when her companion was at her side.

"Be back in a couple hours, okay?"

"I will, and again, thank you so much. I owe you!"

"You owe me nothing but a hug and that amazing tea you make." Scorpia chuckled.

"Deal!"

Scorpia smiled, waving before Melog cloaked both themself and Catra in invisibility, and they were out the door right under Shadow Weaver's nose.

Chapter 3: A Girl Like Me

Chapter Summary

> Catra and Glimmer finally meet, and immediately share a connection. During their first meeting, Glimmer learns a little more about her kingdom from outsider's eyes, and Catra learns that maybe royalty isn't so bad. Some of them anyway.

Princess Glimmer had sparkles in her eyes as her carriage rolled into the village. She hadn't been outside the castle walls since she was a little kid. Now she was dressed in a simple lavender gown and a cape for a disguise, not having to worry about being recognized, and not dressed in layers upon layers of lace and sequins.

"Thank you so much for this, Bow." Glimmer smiled, looking around in awe as she was led through the village, "So, which place was yours?"

"I mean, it was more of a room, but over there. Third floor." Bow pointed to a tall building, clearly a bookstore or library on the lower floor, "My dads run a library and we live upstairs. It's always nice when I get to visit them."

"No wonder you're so smart." Glimmer snorted, "You grew up literally surrounded by books."

Blushing, Bow glanced away, "Well, I did do all of my studies there." He admitted, rubbing the back of his neck.

"How cute." The princess teased, smiling lovingly up at him.

"Heh…" A little embarrassed, Bow distracted the conversation by approaching a stand, picking a lilac flower, and handing it to Glimmer.

"Awe, my favorite, but you knew that." Her tone was affectionate and teasing as she held the flower, “Thank you!” Her face was now turning red just like Bow's already had. With care, she tucked the flower behind her ear, letting the hood of her cape protect it.

"Of course," He smiled. Then, remembering his favorite tavern was just around the corner, Bow smiled. "I'll be right back." He said, giving her shoulder a gentle squeeze before walking off.

Glimmer hummed, continuing to walk a little ways. Her attention was quickly diverted by a hammering sound. She turned and frowned when she realized it was a family business being closed down; it felt like a stab in the heart as she remembered this was the reason she had to go through with this loveless marriage in the first place. She sighed as she kept walking forward, her eyes watching the sad scenery around her. She was so distracted that she failed to notice a girl turn the corner, seemingly coming out of nowhere, ramming right into her and sending them both to the ground.

"I'm so sorry!" Both girls exclaimed at the same time as they scrambled to try and help each other back to their feet.

Once off the ground, the two fell into an awkward staring contest, before Glimmer cleared her throat, "Again, I am so sorry, I wasn't watching where I was going."

"It's alright, miss." The brunette replied, dusting off her skirt and adjusting her own cloak, "I don't think I recognize you. Are you new around here?"

"Not…quite- kinda?"

"What's your name?"

"Oh- uhm, Glimmer…"

"Glimmer? You have the same name as the princess."

"Haha- weeell.." Blushing nervously, looking away as the information clicked.

"Oh!" Eyes widening in realization, she scrambled to correct herself, "I'm Catra, Your Highness." She said quickly with a slight curtsy, "Aren't you supposed to be.. inside the castle?"

"I'm savoring a first and last taste of freedom before getting married next week…to a complete and total stranger."

“Eesh, and I thought being a servant sucked.”

“What?” Glimmer furrowed her eyebrows as she looked at her new acquaintance.

“Nothing!” Catra smiled. Carefully, she pushed her hood off her head, revealing her long brown curls that rested over her shoulders. Her waves of hair complimented the burgundy and gray dress she had on, and the black cape she had still clipped around her shoulders. Even when Glimmer managed to look away from the magicat's attire and hair, they fell immediately onto her mix matched eyes for a moment until she realized they were just staring at each other.

"Well.. in any case, it's lovely to meet you, Catra." Glimmer blushed, pushing her own hood off her head, feeling it was only fair, "And again, I'm sorry for slamming into you. You just-came out of nowhere."

"That would be Melog's fault, sorry." Catra laughed, motioning down to the feline, who meowed at the princess, peeking out from behind their owner, "They're uh, part alien. They can cloak themselves and anyone around them invisible at will. I was kinda sneaking out.."

"Ahh, gotcha. What I would give for a companion like that. Granted, I know a few spells to help, but you know."

The two laughed, starting to walk together down the street. After a moment of silence, Catra felt comfortable enough to speak again, “Hey, if you’d like I could show you around a little. There’s a lot to do and see if you know where to look.” She explained, offering a hand.

“That doesn’t sound suspicious at all.” The princess replied sarcastically, but still smiling.

“Enough to reject my offer?”

“I'll take my chances,” Glimmer took the magicat’s hand, letting her guide them down the pathway and to what looked like the village square. The princess’ eyes widened when she was greeted with a party- or small get together, that seemed like a more appropriate title. A few villagers were playing instruments, others were eating and talking, and a few were even dancing to the music, “Wow…” Glimmer’s smile was enough of a positive reaction for Catra to be satisfied.

“Never been to a party before, princess?”

“Not like this. The ones I’ve been to are more.. formal?”

“Well, I wouldn’t know about that, but I know this is my favorite place to be when I need to get away from… y’know…” Catra trailed off suddenly, she didn’t want to spill her sob story to the princess, but she knew it was probably obvious she had a horrible living situation.

“Life?”

“Yeah, life.” The brunette smiled.

“Well, care for a dance to tell me about it?” Now Glimmer was the one offering her hand, “You’ve been kind enough to bring me here, the least I could do is give you an open place to vent.”

"How generous, your Highness." Catra hummed, taking her hand, while her free hand held her skirt so she could give a quick curtsey.

Giggling, the girls began a simple waltz to the music, Glimmer taking the lead despite being shorter. It was a welcome change for the brunette.

"So.. servant huh?"

Catra's ears dropped against her head, "Heh, yeah.. My uh, my moms passed when I was young and owed Shadow Weaver money and.. here I am."

Glimmer frowned as she was twirled around and against her friend's chest, "I'm so sorry to hear that… I know who Shadow Weaver is, we buy most of my clothing from her."

"I know," Catra chuckled, smiling as she glanced over what the princess was wearing, "I made the dress you're wearing."

"Really?" Glimmer looked up at the brunette.

"Yeah, I was really confused when I made it why royalty would need something so simple. I honestly figured it was meant to be a nightdress. Guess now I have my answer."

"Makes me wonder how many of my dresses you've made." Glimmer smiled, gasping when Catra suddenly dipped her.

"I'd wager.. probably a lot, Sparkles."

"Sparkles?" The princess giggled, blushing as she was lifted back to her feet.

"What? Your hair and eyes sparkle every time you move, seems fitting enough."

"How flattering," Glimmer giggled, bowing to her dance partner as the music came to a close, "I must admit, this has been the best day I've had in a long time. It's so refreshing to talk to someone who understands me."

"What do you mean?"

"I mean.. It's clear you hate your living situation. You want freedom and the chance to live and travel wherever you want.. marry whoever you want. That's what I want.. The- freedom."

"Ah, yeah I'm not gonna lie, I'll take sewing for a witch over an arranged marriage."

"I think I would too." Glimmer giggled, "But seeing you and the village today has given me a lot to think about. Once this whole marriage thing does happen I.. I want to make sure family businesses are saved and that nobody is stuck on the street. I want to make sure everyone has the freedom I'll never have and.. I'm gonna start with you."

Catra's eyes widened, "What..?"

"Like I said, I know who Shadow Weaver is. I knew there was no way she was still making her own clothing, but hearing about you and the situation she's forced you in, I can't stand for it. As soon as I get the chance, I'm paying off your debt."

The brunette felt like the world was mocking her. There was no way this was actually happening. When had anything good- let alone *this* good ever happened to her? There was no reason for it to, "What.. Why?"

"A princess' job is to take care of her people, and you more than deserve it." Glimmer smiled, gently grasping Catra's hand.

"Your Highness.. All I've done for you is knock you to the ground and offer a dance as an apology.."

"And you've been like- the only other person I've ever met outside of my tutor to treat me as a friend and not a high and mighty figure. It doesn't take much to see you're a good person."

"I… wow.." Catra's eyes had glossed over, and she didn't know what else to do, but to pull Glimmer into a hug, "Thank you- s-so much.."

"Thank you." Glimmer giggled, returning the embrace.

The two soon parted, but before Catra could say anything more, she was interrupted by her own name.

"Catra!!"

The magicat gasped when she was roughly grabbed by her wrists and forced to face her employer, "S-Shadow Weaver I-"

"You have all that work waiting and you're out dancing with some random bro-"

"I'd think twice about your word usage, Weaver." Glimmer glared, pushing her hood off her head to reveal who she was.

Eyes widening, the sorceress stumbled over her words before offering a quick curtsey, though not releasing Catra from her vice grip, "Pardon me, Your Highness. I simply am in need of my seamstress, as I'm sure you understand."

Furrowing her eyebrows, Glimmer fixed Shadow Weaver with a glare, "As a matter of fact I-
"

"-Glimmer?!"

Glimmer turned as Bow hurried up to her, "There you are, I was getting worried. I apologize, but we should be getting back."

"Wait, I just need to-"

"It's okay, Your Highness.." Catra promised, offering a smile that was miles from her eyes.

Sighing, Glimmer nodded, "I won't forget about today. I promise."

Nodding, Catra watched the princess and her escort make their way back to their carriage before she was roughly dragged away, "I think you need to be reminded about who you belong to."

The magicat's breath hitched, "W-wait no! Please..!" She immediately tried to free her hands, only for Shadow Weaver to crush her wrists even more underneath her grip, "I- I'm sorry!"

"You will be."

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Glimmer felt like she was ready to just die on the spot. Dinnertime was never all that exciting, but her mother's royal advisor, Horde Prime, had returned from a long journey and had yet to show signs of shutting his mouth long enough to anything outside of drinking his wine.

The temptation to use just a tiny wind spell to color his white suit red with his own drink was ever tempting. She's a firm believer that the only thing that stopped her was her mother

clearing her throat and finally, *finally* , ending Prime's rant.

"I am so glad to hear your mission was a resounding success, Prime. Any wealth you managed to recover will go along splendidly with the marriage alliance with Eternia."

"M-Marriage?!" Prime exclaimed, nearly choking on his drink to keep from spitting it across the table.

"Y..es.." Angella raised an eyebrow, "I know I normally consult you on decisions like this, but you were gone for a month and things are getting desperate. Princess Adora of Eternia is seeking a wife and has graciously agreed to form an alliance with Brightmoon through marriage with Glimmer, and in doing so will see to it our people are helped."

"Trust me, it's a last resort." Glimmer huffed, stabbing her salad with her fork.

While Glimmer didn't notice the way Prime paused, giving the princess an uncomfortably calm smile, Bow did. He was about to say something about it before Prime beat him to it, "So you aren't doing it because you want to?"

"Huh?" Glimmer looked up, glancing between her mother and Prime for a moment before responding, "I.. I want what's best for Brightmoon."

"Of course, Your Highness. I only meant it must be difficult to marry someone you've never met. I'm sure you'd be happier with someone you knew that could save the kingdom."

"I… suppose…" Growing uncomfortable, Glimmer set her silverware down.

"We all wish there were better circumstances when it comes to Glimmer's hand in marriage." Angella sighed.

"If it's not a burden to you, Your Majesty, I may have a few options," Prime hummed, "Might I request a meeting after dinner?"

"Of course, Prime. I look forward to your ideas, but you must keep in mind that Eternia's ambassador arrives the day after tomorrow."

"Right… of course."

"Excuse me, I think I'm going to head to bed." Glimmer cut in, rising from her seat and making her way out of the dining room.

Bow bit his lip, narrowing his eyes, "I think I'm going to do the same. I hope you have an.. enlightening meeting, Your Majesty." He stood, bowing before also leaving the room, his eyes narrowing the second his gaze was away from the table. Something was definitely going on with Prime. He was planning something. What, he wasn't sure yet, but he did know he didn't like it whatsoever. Still, there wasn't much he could do now but keep an eye on Prime, and make sure he kept his distance from Glimmer.

Chapter 4: How Can I Refuse?

Chapter Summary

Prime forms a plan to patch the small setback of Glimmer and Adora's engagement.

Glimmer goes missing.

Horde Prime had been a loyal servant to King Micah and Queen Angella for his entire adult life. However, he'd always had a secret plan of his own to become more than just a royal advisor to the royal family of Brightmoon. He wanted to be king, not just of Brightmoon, but all of Etheria, but had to start somewhere. He was patient, and had been playing his cards right so far.

His hand so far had managed to remove King Micah from the picture, and a recent journey to the Crimson Waste had put enough gold in his pockets to save the kingdom he'd been slowly draining from the inside out. With a little help from thieves of the Waste he'd hired, he'd been able to successfully drain the wealth of Brightmoon and transfer almost all of it to his own hand. He'd made the sacrifice to pay off his help of course, but it was merely a penny's worth of the fortune in his mind.

His original plan had been to return with wonderful news of his mission, how he'd gained enough wealth to save the kingdom himself. He would tell the queen he would be more than happy to provide Brightmoon with what they needed, asking only for her daughter's hand in return, and ensuring his place on the throne. After that all it would take is another little.. accident, for the queen, and then the throne would be his! Whether that bratty princess stayed by his side or in a prison cell would all depend on how she behaved.

Unfortunately, his plan never got past the first step, because he returned to find the queen had promised Glimmer's hand to another princess in his absence! It had taken all of his willpower not to explode with rage when the news reached his ears, but he managed to calm down, and come up with a new plan by the end of the day.

It was painfully clear Glimmer wanted about as much to do with this arranged marriage as she did with her royal duties in general, but perhaps he could fix both of their problems.

All he needed to do was make sure that Glimmer was.. out of the way just long enough for the marriage to be called off, then he would be free to "rescue her" and bring her to the altar himself.

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"Glimmer?"

"Hm..?" The princess yawned, still not opening her eyes.

"If you want to go to sleep you should probably head to bed."

"Mm, but you're comfortable…" Glimmer whined. She'd taken refuge in sleeping on Bow's shoulder while he'd read to her.

Blushing furiously, the tutor had to clear his throat and take a moment before he could continue, "Well, we can't stay here all night, Your Highness. You have a big day tomorrow."

"Ughh, finnnee…" Glimmer slowly sat up, stretching as she got to her feet, "Think we can have our lesson before the ambassador arrives tomorrow?"

"If you'd like, Your Highness." Bow smiled.

"Ugh, stop with the formality, we've known each other forever." She teased, smiling back at him, "I'll see you in the morning."

"Goodnight, Glimmer."

"Night, Bow." The pinkette hummed, waving before she made her way out of the library.

Her mind couldn't help but wander as she made her way down the empty hallway. Her heart ached every time she thought about having to marry someone who wasn't Bow. She had tried to make peace with the situation knowing that she would always have him as a friend, but the closer the wedding got, the less that felt like enough.

At this point she almost wished he would make it clear he didn't feel the same way, so at least she could feel slightly less bad about marrying the Eternian Princess.

Glimmer slowly pushed open her bedroom door, letting it fall shut behind her. She began to make her way over towards her changing screen when she felt a cool breeze sweep past her. Shivering, she looked over to see that her balcony door was open, "Huh… that's weird…"

After taking a glance around, she slowly approached the door, reaching over to close it, when her wrists were suddenly grabbed and she was yanked against someone's chest. A hand and cloth covered her mouth and nose before she had a chance to scream. She began to struggle, searching through her panic for enough focus to cast a spell. Before she could however, she felt her wrists be pressed together, and within moments, she was unconscious in the intruder's arms.

⚔

"Glimmer?" Angella called, worry etched on her face as she walked into her daughter's room. Bow was at her side, equally as concerned when the room was found empty, "Where could she be? It isn't like her to skip breakfast like this…"

"Not without telling someone at least.." Bow frowned, biting his lip anxiously.

"Is that something on her desk, Your Majesty?" Prime asked mere seconds after entering the room as well. Not suspicious at all to Bow, but he was curious, and followed the queen over to the desk, where Prime was skimming a piece of paper, "I believe this is addressed to you." He said, passing the note to Angella, who gasped after reading its contents.

"It says she's run away to avoid marrying Princess Adora!"

While Prime offered a faux gasp, Bow furrowed his eyebrows, "What? That.." That made absolutely no sense to him. Even if she had planned something like that, he couldn't imagine she'd do so without telling him! Then again, she'd met that seamstress in the village the other day… "May I see that, Your Majesty?"

Though distraught at what could have happened to Glimmer, Angella handed the note to Bow, who inspected the handwriting and word choice, as well as the scent of the stationary, "Weird.."

"What?" Prime asked, narrowing his eyes.

"Nothing.. Just odd that this is scented with rose. Glimmer has always scented her stationary with lilac."

"She could have made a few changes. I think you should be focused on where she's run off to before she gets hurt, not what scents she uses on her notes and incense."

"He's right, Bow. We need to send out search parties immediately. I can't imagine she's gotten far. Come along, Prime." Angella said, quickly leaving the room, her advisor trailing behind her.

Bow still wasn't convinced though. He knew Glimmer. She liked her things to be a certain way, and it was *very* rare she changed them. While he seriously doubted she'd actually run away, if she had he was convinced it was to see that seamstress she'd met, so he would just have to start there.

Either way, he *would* find Glimmer, and whether she'd run away or not, he was convinced that Prime had something to do with it.

He just needed to prove it.

Chapter 5: To Be a Princess

Chapter Summary

Catra agrees to pose as Princess Glimmer so Bow can trick Prime into revealing where he's keeping the princess.

Chapter Notes

TW// Lash wounds

Okay, so when Catra is posed at Glimmer I refer to her as 'Glimmer' to make it obvious for you guys, and myself tbh lol.

This was one of my favorite chapters to write just because of the cute Bow/Catra friendship going on

Catra hissed as she clung to her pillow, squeezing her eyes closed as she tried to let Scorpia change the bandages on her back.

"Sorry, Wildcat.. I'm trying to be gentle.."

"I-I know…" Catra whimpered, gasping when Scorpia replaced new bandages over her lash wounds.

After Shadow Weaver had dragged her back the other day, she'd whipped her for nearly half an hour before leaving her in a bloody mess on the floor. Catra's convinced she would have bled out if it weren't for Scorpia and Melog.

"Okay, Wildcat. The ointment should kick back in within ten minutes or so."

"Thank you…" the brunette whispered, before burying her face back into her pillow.

"Of course. I'm gonna catch up on some of the orders, you just lay there and rest for today."

"Scorp, I can't let you do that…" Catra groaned, forcing herself to turn her head to face her friend, "I can still do some things."

"Catra you've been working your tail off, please just rest for now."

"But-"

"-No buts."

The stern look from her friend made it clear Catra wasn't going to win the argument. So, she relented and hugged her pillow once more.

She was able to rest for another hour before the door was opened and Shadow Weaver entered, "Catra!"

Flinching, the magicat looked up, "Shadow Weaver please.. I- I promise I'll get back to work soon I just-"

"-that's not why I'm here. Someone is here to see you. Get dressed, now."

Her ears flicked up immediately with interest, "Who..?"

"I believe it was the escort that was with Princess Glimmer the other day. Why he wants to see *you* is beyond me." She scoffed before leaving the room and slamming the door closed once again.

"Maybe the princess sent him about what she promised you?" Scorpia suggested, gently helping Catra to her feet before beginning to help her get on her bodice once again.

"I'd be surprised if she ever actually went through with that, Scorpia. I doubt she'd forget on purpose, but she has so much more on her plate than a random servant seamstress-" She hissed when Scorpia tightened the ribbon on her bodice a little too much.

"Sorry!"

"It's okay.." Catra gasped, taking a deep breath, "Alright, I'll be back I guess." She slipped on her flats, giving Scorpia a gentle hug before making her way outside, Melog hurrying along by her side.

⚔

"Bow, was it..?" Catra asked when she approached the tutor, loosely hugging herself.

"Hello, yes! You're Catra, correct?"

Nodding, the brunette glanced around before looking back at him, "Why are you here?"

"It's… a lot, but I just need to know if Princess Glimmer showed up here within the last day."

"What?" Catra raised an eyebrow, "Why would she come here? She told me herself she like-never gets to leave the castle." The increasingly worried expression brought concern to Catra's face as well, "...what happened to her?"

This time, Bow was the one to look around, making sure they were alone before continuing, his voice lower, "She's missing. She disappeared last night, and I need you to help me find

her."

"M-Me?" Tail swaying and fluffing with nerves, Catra took a step back, "What could I possibly do?"

"There was a note on her desk this morning that said she ran away to avoid the wedding."

"I don't blame her. Maybe you should-"

"-Just listen," Bow held up a hand, "I don't think she ran away. She likes things in a very particular way, and that includes the scent of her stationary. She always uses lilac, but the note was scented with rose."

".. So?"

"On top of that, Prime, Queen Angella's royal advisor coincidentally found that note within seconds of coming into the room after making it suspiciously clear last night that he was wealthy now and that Glimmer should marry someone she knows."

"...okay, yeah, that's kinda creepy." Catra bit her lip, "Still, I don't understand what I can do to help here."

"I need you to pretend to be Princess Glimmer."

Catra gasped, eyes widening, "What? Are you crazy? Are you trying to get me hanged or imprisoned?!"

"I know it's risky, but I think if it seems like she's returned I can trick Prime into revealing where he's hidden her."

"I…" The brunette paused to think on the plan for a moment before shaking her head, "Wait wait wait. Even *if* I agreed to this, you have *multiple* problems. One, I'm a completely different species and race than her, I'm taller, I have different hair, eyes-"

"-Yes yes I know, but you two *do* act a lot alike, and looks can be fixed with an illusion spell." Catra stared at him, ears pinning against her head, "Please, Catra. I know this is risky, but so much more is at stake if Prime gets his way. It was clear you two connected, and became friends when you met."

Catra closed her eyes, taking a deep breath as she thought it over. If she did this and the plan worked somehow, she would get a few days of freedom from Shadow Weaver, and save a friend in the process. If it failed… well, she would still be free from Shadow Weaver. At this point she really had nothing to lose. She sighed, "Alright, I'll help."

Smiling, Bow threw his arms around Catra in a hug, "Thank you!"

The magicat hissed immediately, "Ow ow ow!"

"What?! What's wrong?" He asked, pulling away in alarm.

"Nothing! Nothing.. Let's just.. let's just get this over with. And.. please don't touch my back again."

Despite how the tutor was now also worried for Catra, he had to focus on one thing at a time. Nodding, he offered a hand, before guiding her to his carriage, Melog in tow as the three began their rush back to the castle.

⚔

Prime held a calm smirk as he finally pulled the reins, halting his horse in front of a cabin in the middle of the woods. Silently, he dismounted, brushing any dust off his jacket, before approaching the door. He only knocked three times.

The door was answered by a man a little under his height. He smiled upon seeing his hired boss, "Everything went according to plan. She's secured."

"Does she have any idea that I'm behind this?"

Scurvy chuckled, "She hasn't even woken up yet, but she won't have any idea. She didn't even get a glimpse of me or Sea Hawk before we knocked her out."

"See to it that she doesn't. Keep her here until the wedding is canceled, then I'll return to 'rescue' her, and then we'll see who she marries." Prime chuckled, smirking and handing two small bags of gold to Scurvy, "There's the payment for this part, you'll receive the rest afterwards."

"Whatever you say, Boss." He smiled.

When turning to leave, a thought came to Prime's mind, "Oh, and one more thing. Make sure her hands remain secure. The brat is quick to use her magic."

"Already taken care of, sir."

"Perfect."

⚔

The Brightmoon palace had always been beautiful to Catra, but getting to see it up close, and even go inside was a new experience entirely. Her tail wagged, her hand gripping onto her cape as she allowed Bow to lead her into Glimmer's bedroom, "Whoa…"

"I know, it's a lot. I remember the first time I came here." Bow smiled, closing the door quietly before making his way over to a bookshelf while Catra carefully removed her cape.

"You know, Bow.. You're still missing a little detail about all of this."

"What's that?" The tutor asked, looking away from the shelf to the brunette.

"I have absolutely zero idea how to be a princess."

Bow chuckled, "Luckily, I do." He looked back at the shelf long enough to grab a book before crossing the room to Catra's side again.

"Gh- what..?" Catra couldn't help but crack an amused smile.

"Well, you didn't just assume I was only her escort did you? I've been tutoring her for a decade on everything from history to math to princess etiquette. Besides, you and Glimmer are really similar. You may not look alike, but you're both stubborn, headstrong, a little sassy, and both want to do the right thing, even if it's at your expense."

Catra felt her cheeks and the tips of her ears flush red, "You've barely met me. How could you know any of that?"

"Glimmer wouldn't stop talking about you when we had to come back."

Her blush only seemed to get worse. To avoid anymore compliments or comments that would only serve to fluster her further, Catra cleared her throat, "Alright, so where do we start?"

"That's the easy part. Looks," Bow exclaimed, eyes lighting up as he took her wrist and brought her over to Glimmer's closet, opening it to reveal hundreds of dresses.

"The fact that Scorpia and I made over half of these…" Catra chuckled as she looked over the array of dresses.

"You're both incredibly talented. There's a few in here that I believe will fit.." He mused, scanning the hangers until he found what he was looking for, "Aha! See?" He smiled, showing Catra the gown he'd produced. The sight made her cringe.

The dress was pastel pink with a purple sash decorating the skirt. It had a sweetheart neckline and purple half sleeves attached to the pink bodice, "Yuuup, I see alright."

"I know this obviously isn't your style, but it's Glimmer's, and once I give you the amulet I was talking about, you'll look like her too." He carried the dress over to the changing screen, draping it over the top, "Let me know if you need help with the ribbons or anything."

Catra only nodded before ducking behind the screen. She carefully undid the lace of her dress before letting it pool around her ankles. She was able to step into the new gown pretty easily, but struggled to reach the ribbons to hold it up. So, she called for Bow, using her hands to hold the front of the bodice up and keep her long hair out of the way.

"What do you- *what happened* ?!" Bow's eyes widened when they landed on the lash wounds covering most of her back.

Catra mentally swore. She had completely forgotten! "Oh, uh that…" she cleared her throat, turning to face him, "Yeah that.. that's what happened after Shadow Weaver dragged me back when you two left.."

"Wh- but- *why* ?!" Tears welled up in his eyes.

"She gets off on torturing me. It's alright, I can barely feel them. Just- be careful please."

"When this is all over, I will make sure Glimmer doesn't forget her promise. That woman deserves prison. Worse even," He carefully began to lace up the bodice once Catra turned

around. His heart ached whenever Catra would flinch or quietly whimper, "There." He said gently, taking Catra's hand and leading her to a chair for her to sit, "All we need now is some shoes, the necklace, and a crash course on princess etiquette!"

The magicat nodded, watching as Bow retrieved purple heels from the closet and gingerly slipped them on her feet before standing back up, "Now the amulet." He hummed, making his way to Glimmer's desk where he'd placed his satchel before going to find Catra.

"How did you even get a hold of something like that anyway?"

"Glimmer's aunt, Castaspella. I went to her a few hours ago and explained everything. She agreed to help as long as I keep in touch with how the mission is going. If I stop responding to her, she knows we need help."

Nodding, Catra stood when Bow approached with the amulet. It looked like a choker, the fabric a deep blue with a bright blue gem attached. When Bow hesitated at first, Catra slowly nodded, closing her eyes as she felt the amulet be clipped around her neck.

Immediately she smelled magic surrounding her, but didn't have the guts to look yet. Meanwhile, Bow was blushing furiously when the sight of his best friend and lifelong crush appearing in front of him once more, "It worked!"

"Mmm… do I wanna look-" Catra cut herself off at the drastic change in her voice. Slowly, she opened her eyes as she was led to a body length mirror. Sure enough, she now looked exactly like Glimmer, from the hair to the skin tone to her height. The voice change was what really hit the brunette though, "This is weird." She looked over when Bow didn't respond, as he was still just staring at her. It took her about three seconds to figure things out, and she smirked, "Do you have a crush on Sparkles?" She giggled, putting a hand on her hip.

Squeaking, Bow looked away, "Please don't do that when you're wearing that. We both know it would never happen, and she doesn't feel that-"

"-Whoa whoa *what* ? I've known her like.. for an hour and I can tell you she would be a million times happier with you than any possible suitor on Etheria."

The thought made him giddy, but the feeling was very momentary, ".. Even *if* she did, social statuses and the whole arranged marriage are in the way. But that doesn't matter. The ambassador is arriving soon and we have a lot to teach you!" He piped up, clasping his hands together before grabbing the book he'd gotten earlier, "Now, let's get started. No nagging, bragging, sweating, fretting, tripping.."

⚔

Catra had a migraine. The amount of information that had been crammed into her skull in the past hour was enough to make her want to take a week-long nap.

"Okay, I think that just about covers it. Questions?" Bow asked, closing his book and looking up at the disguised seamstress.

"Yeah, several." She deadpanned.

Before she could actually ask anything, however, a bell was heard outside, making them both flinch.

"What's that?"

"The ambassador is here." Bow replied, hurrying to grab the circlet tiara off its stand and gingerly placing it on Catra's head, "Just- do your best okay? I'll be next to you the whole time."

"Okay…" Catra whimpered, taking his offered arm and allowing him to guide her out of the bedroom and downstairs.

This was it, she was either going to help save her friend or be found out immediately and be sentenced to death.

She heard conversation when they came within twenty feet of the throne room door.

"This is an outrage!"

"I'm sure we'll find her!"

"It's clear the princess does not wish to be in this arrangement, therefore-"

"-Wait!" Bow exclaimed, pushing open the door, "May I present- uh- Princess Glimmer!" He said, not missing the wide eyes and nervous expression Prime presented the moment that 'Glimmer' stepped into the room.

Catra felt her stomach drop as soon as she saw all eyes on her. She put on a smile as she slowly entered, putting all of her focus on the heels she was walking in. How she hated those things.

"Glimmer?" Angella gasped, quickly approaching, "Where have you been?!"

Catra had to fight down any reaction when she was enveloped in a hug from the *queen* .

"I…" She glanced at Bow, who nodded, clearly just as nervous as she was, "I'm sorry.. I-should not have run away."

"Please promise me you'll never do it again. What brought such a thing on?"

Bow watched Prime, who was glaring at 'Glimmer', but also seemed… confused.

Catra had never been much of an actress outside of hiding her pain and gulping down her rage, but even after such a short meeting with Glimmer, she felt like she could answer things like this with ease, "I just panicked, uh- mother." She gave an awkward smile, "I know this arrangement is important, I just felt overwhelmed with it being so sudden."

"I apologize, honey. I really wish things could go at a steadier pace."

"It's alright. I'm ready now."

"That's good to hear, love. In any case, I'd like you to meet the ambassador, Adam."

Turning, Catra was greeted with a young man around her age with short blonde hair. He was wearing a gold jacket with a white button up underneath, white pants that were accented gold accompanying them. After a quick bow, he finally took a few steps to approach, "It's wonderful to meet you, Your Highness." He said with a bow.

"You as well.." 'Glimmer' smiled, returning the gesture with a small curtsey, "I apologize for my delay, I hope Her Highness won't hold it against Brightmoon."

"I can promise you that my sister is quite forgiving." Adam chuckled.

"Sister?" 'Glimmer' asked, surprised.

"Yes, quite the surprise I know. Most people find it odd that the Eternian Prince is the ambassador. There aren't many people my sister trusts with important information about Eternia, so I stepped up at her request."

"How noble of you." 'Glimmer' smiled.

"Well, dinner is waiting, shall we all head to the dining hall?" Angella asked once the conversation seemed to die down.

"I'd love to, but I unfortunately must see to some of the.. arrangements." Prime huffed, giving the princess a sideways look before quickly strolling out of the throne room.

"Arrangements huh…" Bow muttered, turning to follow when the queen called for him.

"Bow, wait! I'd love to hear all about how you found Glimmer!"

"I-.." The tutor bit his lip, seeing the alarmed expression on 'Glimmer's' face, "O-Of course, Your Majesty!" He approached slowly, offering his arm to 'Glimmer' as they all made their way to the dining hall.

Chapter 6: Meetings

Chapter Summary

Catra finally meets Princess Adora.. and the reaction is instant

Glimmer groaned as she struggled against the ropes holding her to the chair. She had woken up alone, and had remained alone since, only hearing faint conversation in the next room, "You could at least face me and tell me my ransom you cowards!" If she could just get her arms free, she could surely find a spell to help her escape!

She growled when she was all but ignored, leaving her in the dark. She sighed, hanging her head. How did she get herself into this?

⚔

Catra stretched, yawning as she slowly opened her eyes, "I really thought I was dreaming, Melog.." She whispered, sitting up and looking around the glamorous bedroom.

Melog mewled, licking her arm before curling back up.

"I know, I'm not used to this voice either.." She sighed, putting a hand over the amulet around her neck.

She flinched when a knock came at the door, and she quickly composed herself, "Come in..!" She said, unsure, as she wasn't used to not being barged in on.

"Don't worry, it's just me!" Bow smiled, closing the door behind him, "Sleep well?"

"Better than I have in years.." Catra admitted, yawning as she slid out of bed onto her feet, "Have you gotten any leads?"

"I'm going to confront Prime today about how.. odd things have been while you meet Princess Adora."

"While I *what* ?" She looked alarmed, eyes widening.

"We talked about this at dinner, Catra. I know it's scary, but you really nailed it yesterday. You don't have anything to worry about."

"If you say so…"

"Let's get you ready, then. We have breakfast before the meeting, so you have some time to prepare."

⚔

After breakfast, Bow left 'Glimmer' to prepare for the meeting with Angella while he followed Prime outside to the courtyard, "Prime. A word?" He called, slowly approaching. Bow remained a few steps back though, as Prime was much taller.

"I'm surprised to see you out here. Shouldn't you be supporting the princess in her meeting? Or is it too painful?" Prime asked, smiling calmly, almost smirking.

Bow fought down a blush. Did everyone know about his feelings *except* Glimmer?!

Instead of answering, he cleared his throat, "I just wanted to ask about your own thoughts. You seemed pretty upset to learn about the engagement. Did it interfere with your own plans?"

"My plans are of little importance to you." Prime furrowed his eyebrows, "I'd suggest sticking to your books. It'll be better than sticking your nose into business it doesn't belong."

Prime turned on his heel and headed inside before Bow could say another word.

⚔

Catra took a few deep breaths before slowly walking into the throne room. She saw a new blonde in the room next to Adam. She was the same height, but with longer hair, and wore a red suit with golden accents, a circlet crown on her head.

The moment their eyes met, Catra felt her entire world stop. She was so… beautiful.

The way Adora's ocean eyes captivated Catra's entire being were enough of a distraction to lose focus on her heels and come crashing to the floor.

"Are you alright?!" Adora asked, immediately offering a hand. 'Glimmer' laughed awkwardly, taking her hand and rising to her feet, taking her time in pulling away.

"I'm okay, your highness. I just…heels?"

Adora laughed, a sound that was music to Catra's ears, "I understand. I haven't worn the things in years."

Blushing, the disguised seamstress glanced away.

"But by any means, it's an absolute honor to meet you, *your highness* ." The way Adora said that seemed almost.. teasing.

"Are we not supposed to be so formal?" 'Glimmer' asked, an amused smile forming.

"According to traditions, but I'd be happy with you simply calling me Adora."

'Glimmer's' blush only deepened, "Then you can call me Ca-" She caught herself by clearing her throat, "Glimmer. My name is Glimmer."

"Well, it's lovely to finally meet in person, Glimmer." Adora smiled, gently taking her hand and pressing a light kiss to the princess' hand.

Catra felt like her heart was going to stop. Why was Adora so *charming* ?

"It's an honor to meet you as well, A-Adora.."

"I do apologize that this arrangement isn't in the most normal of circumstances, but the wedding isn't until next week, so I hope we can use this time to get to know each other."

"I'd love that, thank you.."

"Well then, Glimmer, would you perhaps mind taking a walk in the courtyard with me?" Adora asked, offering her arm.

"I'd love to.." 'Glimmer' smiled, blushing as she gently took Adora's arm, allowing the blonde to guide her out to the courtyard.

Angella and Adam watched with fond smiles as the two left the throne room.

⚔

Glimmer took a deep breath as she continued to blindly fidget with the knot binding her wrists behind her. She'd made some progress in the past few hours, and hoped that she'd soon finally break free.

She tensed and stopped when she heard the door knob wiggling, sitting up and glaring at her two captors as they entered, "Have you finally come to tell me what my ransom is?"

Sea Hawk chuckled, "Your ransom?"

"Why else would you kidnap a princess? I can't imagine what else you'd want other than money." Glimmer spat.

"Valid point, Your Highness," Scurvy smirked, "I suppose the question is really where we choose to get said ransom money from."

"W-What..?" Panic finally made its way onto Glimmer's face for the first time.

"Everyone knows Brightmoon is one bad harvest away from ruin. I'm willing to bet we could fetch a much heftier price for you in the Wastes."

"N-no, no.. my- my fiance is the Princess of Eternia… and she's in Brightmoon by now I'm sure… whatever you want they c-can get!"

"You better hope so," Scurvy's smirk widened, using his pointer finger to hook under Glimmer's chin and force eye contact, "Because if we don't have that answer in a few days, well, we have a wagon outside ready for you."

Whimpering, Glimmer jerked her head away, fighting tears until her captors left the room, locking her in once more.

The thought of never seeing her mother or Bow again was terrifying. She'd only heard rumors about the Crimson Waste, and she *never* wanted to experience life there, much less as an auctioned princess in the wrong arms.

More determined, she continued to try and undo the knots on the ropes, blinking back tears every so often.

She would get free, and she would show these monsters they messed with the wrong princess.

Chapter 7: If You Love Me for Me

Chapter Summary

Catra is starting to fall for someone she knows she could never have.

'Glimmer' smiled and blushed when Adora presented her with a rose halfway through their walk in the gardens.

Throughout the past three days, the two had spent the majority of their days together, talking about whatever, sharing meals, and swapping memories like they were childhood friends. Granted, most of Catra's were sugar coated versions of real memories of hers; she did her best to be honest.

She'd even found time to introduce Adora to Melog, whom the blonde fell in love with almost immediately. The feline was currently running around the garden ahead of them, enjoying the open space and beautiful flora.

"I never thought I would connect with someone as much as I have with you, princess." Adora smiled, gently lacing an arm around 'Glimmer's' waist.

"I could say the same thing to you, Your Highness." 'Glimmer' blushed, idly twirling a rose Adora had given her between her fingers.

"I'm thankful you allowed me to take you on another walk, but I do have a meeting with my brother. May I walk you back to your room?"

"Of course, thank you."

Nodding, Adora whistled to get Melog's attention, and the three began walking back inside.

⚔

As they approached the bedroom door, Adora stopped and gave 'Glimmer' an admiring expression.

"What?" 'Glimmer' giggled.

"There's something about you. You're so.. honest, no pretenses. I like that." Adora smiled, pressing a kiss to the back of her hand before stepping back, "Until dinner, Your Highness." She said, before turning and making her way down the hall.

Flustered, Catra hurried into the bedroom and shut the door, relieved to find Bow at the desk.

"How was the date?" Bow asked, raising an eyebrow.

Catra groaned after removing the amulet, needing a moment to feel like she belonged in her own body, "This is a disaster! *Honest* ? *No pretenses* ? Sparkles is still missing, the wedding is in four days and I.. Bow, I think I'm falling in love with Princess Adora!"

Tensing, the tutor got to his feet and approached his friend, "Yeah that was- not supposed to happen."

"Have you gotten *any* leads on where she is?!"

"Yes actually. Prime snuck off into the Whispering Woods the other day, and I believe he's hidden her there."

"Great. So how do you plan to get her back *here* ?"

"I'm going to find her tonight, okay?"

Nodding, Catra groaned, lightly butting her head against Bow's chest, "Being a princess is exhausting."

"Hopefully you won't have to do it anymore after tomorrow…" He sighed. He understood the pining pain of unrequited romance she was suffering from. He wished things could work out for them both.

If only.

⚔

Glimmer quietly gasped as she finally, *finally* broke through the ropes binding her to the chair, "Yes..!" She whispered, getting to her feet. Her last obstacle was the door, but that was easy. She could use her magic now. So, after reading a spell to freeze them where they stood, she sent a beam through the tiny window to shatter it and gain her captors' attention.

She heard Scurvy ask what the noise was, before both of them rushed to the room, throwing the door open, and walking right into Glimmer's trap.

"Sorry to cut our time together short." She smirked, watching them fail to fight against her spell, "Don't worry, it'll wear off in a couple of hours." She tossed them another smirk before running out of the cabin and climbing into the driver's seat of the wagon, cracking the reins, "Go, go, go!" She encouraged, not quite feeling safe until the cabin was out of her line of sight.

⚔

Bow kept a close eye on Prime as he followed him deeper into the Whispering Woods. He had to be going where Glimmer was, he was sure of it!

When they approached a small cabin in a clearing, he hid in the brush as he watched Prime approach and knock three times.

Slowly, the door opened to reveal Scurvy, who looked *very* nervous, "Heyy- boss! Don't worry! Everything is fine! I promise-"

Glaring, Prime pushed past him to tower over both of the idiots he'd hired, "How did she escape?!"

"...Who?" Sea Hawk asked with an unreadable expression.

Eye twitching, Prime crushed his hand into a fist, "The *princess* ! You- ugh!"

"She used her magic and we-" Scurvy was cut off before he could even begin to explain.

"I *told* you to keep her hands secure! When did she escape?"

"Maybe… four hours ago..?" Sea Hawk chuckled nervously, tugging on his bandana.

"Wait- what..?" Now it was Prime's turn to be confused. The princess had been home for longer than that. *Much* longer, "Something isn't adding up here. First the princess returns and says she *did* run away when she was captured. Then you say she only escaped a few hours ago."

Bow furrowed his eyebrows as he quietly approached the window to listen in.

"I need to solve this Princess Puzzle if I'm ever going to be king."

"King… Prime..?" Bow mumbled, thinking it over as the pieces fell into place. Unfortunately, he leaned just a little too hard on the boarded window, and pushed the board down.

He bit his lip, backing up, eyes widening when Prime stepped outside, "Are you looking for something, Bow?"

"Yeah, Glimmer, and how you think you'll ever be-" The tutor was cut off by being roughly grabbed by Scurvy, a cloth covering his mouth and nose seconds later. Though he struggled, it wasn't long before he was unconscious.

⚔

Glimmer shivered as she slowly approached the castle gates, gripping the blanket she was using as a cape. She guided the horse to a halt when she saw the guards standing on the gate balcony.

"Who goes there?"

"P-Princess Glimmer…"

"Ha, if you're the princess, I'm the queen."

"Wh- but I- I *am* the princess!" Glimmer pleaded, tearing up. She was exhausted, scared, and desperately wanted to cuddle with her mom and Bow.

"Uh-huh. I just saw the princess eating dinner with the queen and Princess Adora."

"Wh- what? What do you mean what- what princess?"

"Move along girl, before I lose my temper!"

"You are speaking to Princess Glimmer, let me through, please-"

"I said move alone. *Now* !"

Gasping, and too exhausted to fight anymore, she guided the horse to turn around and head back to the village, tears running down her face.

She made her way to the village, stopping outside of a tavern, hoping to find help. However, she spotted Weaver's Boutique instead, and smiled slightly. Maybe Catra could provide some comfort!

It took a few minutes of searching, but she soon found a doorway in the back down a staircase. She quietly knocked, praying to see a friendly face.

The door opened rather quickly, but instead of Catra, it was a much taller, Scorpioni woman, "Catra-?!" Her eyes widened when she realized who it was, "Oh! Princess Glimmer? My-gosh what brings you by?" She asks, offering a clumsy bow before stepping aside, "Please, come in, it's chilly out there tonight!"

"Thank you…" Glimmer smiled, wiping her eyes, "What's your name..?"

"Oh- how rude, I apologize princess, my name is Scorpia."

"Please- just Glimmer is fine. You answered looking for Catra.. you haven't seen her?"

"No. Your escort, Bow came by maybe, oh when was it… well almost a week ago now, asking for Catra. She went out to meet him and never returned."

"Almost a week..? That's when…" Her eyes widened. There was no way…

"What is it?"

"I- I was kidnapped one night around then… I managed to escape but when I got to the castle the guards turned me away saying that I was already in the castle?"

After taking a minute to process everything, Scorpia gasped, "Do you think Bow is having Catra pretend to be you? But how-?"

"Magic, I'm guessing, but she's in so much danger. If anyone figures out she's impersonating me…"

"Oh, Wildcat..!"

"My guess is Bow was trying to save the engagement, but… I have to find a way back in the castle before she's found out!"

"How?"

"I don't know… I need to find a way to get a message inside, hopefully to Bow or Catra and let them know where I am."

"Hmm.. Oh! I actually had a shipment of new dresses being sent to you tomorrow. You could hide a note in the box."

"Perfect. Do you have paper and a pencil?"

"Of course, right this way, Your Highness."

Chapter 8: A Common Pauper

Chapter Summary

Glimmer's note falls into the wrong hands, and Prime finally makes his move.

Chapter Notes

We are getting to the climax y'all! This chapter was actually so sad to write asjfhd, enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra did her best to steady her breath as she paced back and forth in front of Glimmer's bed, "What am I gonna do, Melog? Bow is still missing and so is Glimmer and I can't keep this up forever! I'm gonna get caught I.." She trailed off upon seeing Melog purring against a box from Weaver's Boutique, "Huh..? I guess I was asleep when they delivered it.."

Approaching, she lifted the lift, looking through the dresses without much care, given she'd made several of them, before seeing a folded piece of paper at the bottom. She grabbed it and returned to pacing slowly as she read it silently.

To Whoever Finds This (Hopefully Catra or Bow):

This is Glimmer. I managed to escape after being kidnapped by two men, I believe their names were Scurvy and Sea Hawk? It was hard to hear their conversations through the wall. I tried to return home only to learn that "I" was already there. I'm not entirely sure what's going on, Scorpia and I have been discussing theories, but we need to fix this before Catra is discovered. I'll be waiting at the boutique.

Please be safe.

Love,

Catra's eyes widened as she reread the contents of the letter a few more times. Glimmer was okay, and that was good. Even better, she likely knew most of what was going on. Without Bow, however, she had no way of getting the princess smuggled back in the castle without them being discovered.

"Oh, Bow, where are you? Why aren't you back yet..?" She gasped when the door suddenly opened, only for Prime of all people to come into the room. She quickly folded the paper and placed it on the desk.

"Well don't you look beautiful, Your Highness!" Prime complimented, only to be stopped from approaching by an angry, hissing Melog, "What's this stupid thing doing here?"

"They belong to me." 'Glimmer' glared.

"Oh, of course, a thousand apologies, my lady. I wasn't aware you'd adopted a new.. companion." He looked at the growling feline with distaste.

"Well, it's not really your business. May I ask what you're doing here?"

"Ah, of course!" Prime clasped his hands together, "The queen has sent me to escort you to meet with Princess Adora."

"Ah…thank you.." 'Glimmer' replied, lightly taking his offered arm as she was led out of the room. She unfortunately missed the moment when Prime noticed the letter on the desk.

⚔

The moment Prime was free of escorting the princess, he immediately snuck back to her bedroom to investigate the note he'd seen her reading. After reading it himself, all of the pieces of the princess puzzle he'd been working to solve finally fell into place.

With a new plan in place, he attended lunch and dinner with the royals to ease any suspicions of the imposter princess, before making his way into the village under the cover of the setting moon.

It only took a few moments after finding the wagon she'd stolen to get there to find the staircase leading down to the entrance he needed.

Once opening the door, he was met with Princess Glimmer sitting down with a Scorpioni seamstress.

When Glimmer saw the newest visitor, she wasn't sure how relieved she really was, "Prime? You found my note?"

"I did, Your Highness.." He smiled, "You must come quickly, you can fill me in on the way to the castle."

Scorpia watched the conversation with concern. She didn't like the way he was talking to Glimmer.

"Why isn't Bow with you?"

"He's busy with Miss.. Catra, was it?"

"Okay…" Glimmer turned to Scorpia as Prime took hold of the princess' arm.

"Be careful, Your Highness." Scorpia said, watching uncomfortably as Glimmer was taken out of the building.

Glimmer carefully took a seat next to Prime as he cracked the reins and the wagon took off down the road, "Now what happened to you, princess? You're a mess."

"Two men broke into my room and kidnapped me around a week ago. They were holding me for ransom, but I managed to escape a few days ago. When I arrived at the palace the guards turned me away because they said I was already in the castle. When I found Scorpia we put the pieces together that Bow brought in Catra, a friend of mine to.. be me? I still don't fully understand either, but I guess he was trying to make sure the wedding didn't get canceled before I was found."

Prime nodded, guiding the horse as Glimmer spoke. Too far into her retelling, Glimmer didn't realize where they were going until it was too late.

"Wait, why are we in the woods..? The castle is.." She trailed off when that same cabin came into view, "Y… *You* were behind this?!" Her eyes widened when a smirk formed on the advisor's face.

"Quite clever of your tutor to find a little magical doppelganger to fool your mother, but not quite clever enough. Checkmate." He chuckled, grabbing her wrists and pressing them together as he dragged her inside.

Glimmer screamed and struggled as she was forced into the same room that had held her prisoner for so long, "Bow?!" She gasped, seeing her best friend tied down to a chair.

"Glimmer!" He exclaimed, being forced to watch as she was forced into a chair against his own, Scurvy tying her down by all four limbs to ensure she couldn't escape.

"Why are you doing this?!" She cried, staring at Prime with a desperate gaze.

"To be king of course!" Sea Hawk exclaimed proudly, only to wince when he was shoved away by his partner.

"Why would you- *what* ?"

"Well, initially, I was going to marry you, but this whole mess has made it easier to simply… dispose of you instead. Besides, your mother is quite the handsome widow, and my multi decade plan will not fail now."

Tears ran down Glimmer's face at the implications, "Wait… Y-You… you're the reason my father…" She broke into sobs, staring at the floor.

"Yes… quite the unfortunate incident. It's a shame the same will happen to you two."

"They won't stop looking for her!" Bow glared.

"Oh I have a feeling they will once I reveal that little imposter pauper of yours. I think my word will be much heavier over hers."

"No- you- you won't get away with this!"

"I believe I already have. You should have listened when I told you to stick to your books." Prime chuckled, ushering his lackeys out of the room before following, slamming the door behind them and locking it.

"I'm so sorry, Glimmer…" Bow muttered, hanging his head, "I was only trying to help.."

"I know you were, Bow, none of this is your fault. We didn't know…"

"But now Catra is going to be imprisoned or worse, and unrequited love of her own to deal with because of me.."

"Why did you do that anyway? It's the one thing I haven't figured out." Glimmer asked, craning her neck to try and see her best friend.

"I knew Brightmoon could fall if this marriage didn't happen, so I needed a way to keep it going while I searched for you. I was suspicious of Prime from the beginning, but I needed a way to prove it. I thought if he believed you had returned I could trick him into revealing where he hid you…"

"Why didn't you bring your suspicions to mother or General Juliet?"

"I don't know. I- I panicked and- I *did* go to Castaspella, and she's the one who gave me the amulet."

"So that's how you did it." Glimmer chuckled, "It's kind of impressive." She lets the conversation die for a few moments before sighing, "Do you know why I didn't want to marry Princess Adora?"

"You.. weren't ready to get married?"

"No.." Glimmer laughed, "Because I'm in love with someone else…" Unable to use her hands, she simply leaned back to rest her head against his, "My best friend, actually…"

"M-Me? But I-" Bow's face flushed, eyes widening, "I'm not royalty I can't.. I can't give you what she could…"

"You give me everything she *can't* , Bow," Glimmer smiled, "You give me true love, happiness, a person that understands and knows me better than I know myself. You've been there for me ever since I learned how to cast my first spells. I will never be happy in any marriage that isn't with you."

It was Bow's turn to cry now, blushing and smiling like an absolute dork, "I love you too, Glimmer.. so much…" He felt more determined now, furrowing his eyebrows, "We're going to get out of here somehow, I promise."

Glimmer stiffened suddenly, "... I hope that sometime is soon.."

"Why? What's wrong?" He asked, doing his best to try and face her, with little success.

"I smell gasoline."

⚔

"Everything seems to be ready. Our kingdoms shall officially be joined after the wedding. Tomorrow we'll have the official engagement dinner and the day after is the wedding. Are you ready, lovely?"

'Glimmer' smiled nervously, giving an unsure laugh, "Ready! Haha.."

"For my bride to be…" Adora said suddenly, approaching and opening a small box to reveal a beautiful golden ring.

"Whoa..!" 'Glimmer' gasped, eyes wide, "It's beautiful…"

"Almost as beautiful as you, princess." Adora smiled, the two staring at each other, slowly closing the distance until the door suddenly swung open, revealing Prime and two guards, one of them being General Juliet.

"Grab her! She's an imposter!" Prime demanded.

'Glimmer' gasped as she was roughly grabbed by the two guards, "Wh- let me go!"

"Prime! What are you doing?" Angella exclaimed.

"She's a fake, just a common seamstress!"

'Glimmer's' eyes widened.

"Are you trying to tell me I don't know my own daughter?"

"I only just discovered it myself, Your Majesty. I mean have you not wondered where Bow has been lately? He conspired with this- this pauper, and together they took the princess and trapped her in a cabin in the Whispering Woods. They left her there after setting it ablaze."

Now Catra was panicking. If any of that story was true then…

"What proof do you have of such a ridiculous story?" Adora asked, raising an eyebrow.

"While my workers were unfortunately unable to recover anything from the ashes, and Bow seems to have fled, he left this one to take the fall." With a few swift movements, he ripped the amulet from Catra's neck.

"No!" Catra gasped, closing her eyes as magic encased her again, slowly fading away to reveal the brunette magicat in the princess' place.

"I… don't believe it.." Adora gasped.

"I can explain!" Catra tried.

"Throw her in the dungeon!"

"No! Wait!" Catra quickly pulled from the guards to approach Adora, "I.. I'm not Princess Glimmer. But I never hurt her, or anyone else!" Tears ran down her face as she was roughly grabbed and began to be led from the room, "B-Bow and I were trying to rescue her from h-him!" She pleaded, desperate as she was taken from the throne room.

Adora turned to Angella, who was silently sobbing, in a state of shock that her daughter, as well as her husband, were now lost to her.

⚔

Catra whimpered as she curled up against the wall of her cell, ears pinned and tail still against her side. She should have known that this would all end with her in a prison cell. At least she wouldn't have to work for Shadow Weaver anymore.. but she missed Scorpia so much… She wished she could see her at least one more time…

And Bow and Glimmer? Was Prime telling the truth about the fire? Had he really..?

She put a hand over her mouth as she sobbed openly, letting the sounds of her grief and the echoes of water dripping from the sewers lull her into a restless sleep.

Chapter End Notes

Comments and Kudos make my week! I love hearing about what you think of the story and what you think will happen next! <3

Chapter 9: Duos Escape

Chapter Summary

Will Glimmer and Bow escape the fire? Will Catra be able to break free of her jail cell and clear her name? Will the wedding of Prime and Angella happen?! Time to find out as all sides finally come together!

Chapter Notes

Ahhhh this is the chapter that I've been waiting to post and I couldn't wait any longer!!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Glimmer continued to struggle as the smoke began leaking under the doorways, the smell of flame and gas only becoming stronger.

Bow had had a little more luck, being only his arms were restrained like Glimmer's had been the first time. When he finally freed his arms he wasted no time in beginning to work on Glimmer's, "Just hang on, Glimmer, I've gotcha!" He promised.

Without having to work blindly, he was able to quickly undo the ropes around Glimmer's ankles and wrists, freeing her just as the flames finally began to burn through the door.

Glimmer immediately leapt into Bow's arms, clinging to him as the two backed away from the doorway, "How are we getting out of here?"

Looking around, Bow spotted a shovel propped up against the corner near the door, "Stay here." He said before hurrying over and grabbing the tool.

"What are you doing?!"

"We need to break the boards and glass off one of these windows so it'll be big enough to climb through." Bow explained, approaching the window Glimmer had shattered already, beginning to ram the shovel head against the boards in an attempt to break them free.

Glimmer bit her lip, looking around for anything else that could help. Her eyes then landed on the chairs themselves, and got an idea.

"Bow! Move!"

"Wh- Glimmer!" Bow shrieked, moving out of the way just as the princess barreled forward, ramming the chair legs as hard as she could through the window. The force was enough to take Glimmer with it as the legs snapped the old boards from the window, falling through to the ground, while the princess all but smacked her head against the wall.

"Are you okay?!" Bow asked immediately, eyes widening when he saw a small gash on her forehead and a bit of blood coming from her nose.

"I'll be alright, let's just get out of here!"

Unsure, but nodding, Bow quickly and carefully lifted Glimmer by her waist over the window sill and onto the ground, before climbing over himself. The two stayed close as they began to race away from the cabin, just as a small explosion erupted from inside, drawing a shriek from the duo and sending them to the ground, and knocking them unconscious.

⚔

Adora had been relatively silent since Glimmer- Catra- a magicat, had been revealed impersonating the princess and hauled away to prison.

But something just- didn't seem right with Prime's story. How could this girl conspire with that tutor to kidnap Glimmer and secure her somewhere to kill her? She'd spent every day with that girl. Sure, Bow was missing, but that didn't necessarily mean anything.

"Adora, you need to stop focusing on it. Let's just get home, and go from there."

"I can't, Adam. Something else is going on here…" She watched with narrow eyes through the carriage window as Prime watched them depart from a balcony, a smile on his face.

"Well what do you propose we do?"

"I don't know yet, but I'll think of something."

Prime watched Princess Adora, the two making eye contact briefly before the carriage finally pulled away. He smirked, everything was exactly as he needed it to be. Now he just had to put in the final piece of the puzzle.

Casually, he made his way back inside and down to the throne room, where Angella was staring mournfully at a portrait of Glimmer, "So many problems, Your Majesty… I couldn't imagine."

"What is it, Prime?" Angella asked softly, not sparing him even a glance to look away from her daughter's portrait.

"There's just so much happening at once. I'm here to assist."

"You can't bring my Glimmer back."

"True true, but I can provide the answer to saving Brightmoon."

Sighing, the queen turned to her advisor, "What is that?"

"See, I have come upon a very vast fortune recently. That last mission of mine- you could say I struck gold. To keep it short, I am as wealthy as Princess Adora."

Angella furrowed her eyebrows, "What are you saying..?"

"I'm saying that I'm willing to carve half my fortune to you, if you are so willing as to accept my simple proposal…" He made his intentions clear by getting to one knee and presenting a ring box from his jacket pocket.

The queen gasped, eyes widening, "You… You want to marry me?"

"Such a simple thing for such great wealth for your kingdom, I'm sure. So, will you marry me, Your Majesty?"

Angella stared, trying to process what was happening. She knew that this truly was her last hope at saving Brightmoon. She trusted Prime, and she had silently vowed that if she could take an unhappy marriage from Glimmer onto herself she would. So, closing her eyes and holding out her left hand, she fought back tears as the ring was slid

onto her finger over the one Micah had given her so long ago.

⚔

Glimmer slowly woke to the feeling of movement. Panicked, she sat up and looked around, relieved to see the driver of the wagon was Scorpia, Melog by her side, "Scorpia?"

"Hey, Princess. Are you okay? Melog found me and led me to you. I'm glad they did, that was a nasty fire and you two weren't looking good."

Glimmer looked down to see Bow still asleep next to her. They were both covered in dirt, a bit of soot and ash, and their hair was a mess. Not to mention how exhausted they were, "Thank you Melog…" She smiled, giving them a gentle pat on the head. They purred in approval, "Where are we?"

"Almost out of the woods now. We need to get you back to the castle, like yesterday!"

"What? What happened? Oh- is Catra okay?!"

"I think she's still in jail, but even worse, Prime and your mother are getting married- today."

"Mm- who's marrying jail..?" Bow muttered, slowly waking up himself.

"We have to stop a wedding. Apparently my mom is marrying Prime today."

That woke the tutor. He sat up, looking around, "How far away is the castle?"

"Melog is guiding us on a shorter way to get there that isn't through town. I'm guessing give it another half hour. Don't worry, the wedding is an hour away, so we'll have extra time."

Bow nodded, looking at Glimmer, who threw her arms around him, "I missed you… so much…"

"I missed you too.." He smiled, pressing a kiss to her forehead.

"When this is over, I'm marrying you." Glimmer giggled, "If you'll have me of course…"

"Of course I want to marry you, Glimmer. But what about Brightmoon..?"

"I think I know a way to fix that too." The princess said with a smirk.

⚔

Catra had been humming softly for the past hour, carefully lulling the guard on watch to sleep in his chair. She smirked as she quietly approached the cell door. She'd already kicked off her heels the night before. If she had any chance of escaping now, it would be without those blasted things.

She continued the soft melody as she extended her claws, starting to pick the lock as quietly as she could. She paused when the guard shifted, waiting until he relaxed to continue humming and working on the lock.

When it finally clicked, she took a deep breath, watching the guard for a few more seconds before pushing the door open and booking it down the hallway. She remembered the way out from when she was dragged to her cell the night before.

She quickly hid behind a pillar when she heard the guard's footsteps, waiting until they hurried in a different direction to continue towards the exit.

Unfortunately, she turned a corner and ran right into a guard's arms, "No! Let me go!" She yelled, struggling against their firm grip as they held her against them.

"Thought she could escape, huh?" The other guard said upon approaching, "I'll lock her up."

"I'm to take her to the castle." The guard holding Catra said.

"But-"

"-Queen's orders."

"Alright then…"

Catra grunted as she was forced to walk forward. Why would the queen want to see her? Was she going to order her execution?!

Panicked, she started struggling again. When they stepped outside she slammed her foot down on top of the guard's in an effort to escape.

"Hey!" They exclaimed, steadying Catra before finally removing their helmet, "I guess I deserved that." Adora chuckled.

"A-Adora?!" Catra gasped, "I- I need to explain-"

"I don't believe you're who Prime says you are, don't worry." Adora smiled.

"You're.. full of surprises, huh?" The brunette smiled, hugging herself.

"As are you. Now come, we need to hurry. Adam is waiting for us."

Nodding, Catra ran alongside the blonde, still not entirely sure what was happening.

⚔

Angella held a mournful gaze as she walked down the aisle. She'd only opted for a simple wedding veil, not bothering to look Prime in the eye as she approached him.

"Smile, my dear. You're about to become my queen." Prime smiled, gently taking her hand.

"Only to save Brightmoon." Angella cringed, pulling her hand away.

Prime smirked, turning to the minister, who cleared his throat, "We're gathered here today to join Queen Angella and Advisor Horde Prime in the bonds of marriage. Do you, Prime, take this woman to be your bride?"

"Of course I do." Prime smirked.

"And do you, my queen, take this man to be your husband?"

"I…" Angella glanced at the ground, "I…" She sighed, closing her eyes, "I d-"

"Wait! Wait!"

The queen turned at the sudden intrusion, gasping when Glimmer was standing in the middle of the aisle.

"Stop the wedding, mom." Glimmer commanded.

Prime's eyes widened. It couldn't be…

"G-Glimmer?!"

"B-But she's dead, Your Majesty.." Prime tried, "The imposter must have escaped!"

"Yeah, no, Prime." Glimmer glared, igniting a small sparkle illusion from her hand, as it was all she had the energy for. She did manage to send it right into Prime's face though, much to his agitation.

"It is you!" Angella rushed over, pulling her daughter into a secure and loving embrace. Glimmer immediately returned the hug, tears running down her face.

Catra and Adora hurried up with Adam just as Scopria, Bow, and Melog did.

"Glimmer's alive!" Catra smiled, sighing in relief.

"But where were you? I thought.."

"What he wanted you to think." Glimmer glared, pointing at Prime, who gasped and took off as Angella yelled for guards to seize him.

"What if he gets away?" Catra asked, looking at the twins, who shared a look with each other and Bow.

"He won't get away." Adora promised, the trio rushing over to mount horses stationed nearby, "Alright Swifty, you can do this." Adora smirked, cracking the reins as they took off after Prime.

Catra approached Glimmer just as Sea Hawk ran past them, the girls tripping him into a podium of flowers, "Nice to see you again." Glimmer giggled.

Scorpia swung her tail at Scurvy once he was close enough, "Going somewhere?"

The twins rode quickly after Prime, who had managed to get a horse as well.

Bow took a different path, smirking when he pulled out in front of Prime, blocking his path.

Growling, Prime yanked the reins to try and turn around, only to run into the twins, "Yeah, I don't think so." Adora glared, smiling when General Juliet and a few other guards approached to detain Prime.

After Sea Hawk and Scurvy were arrested, Catra finally turned to see Scorpia and Melog. She smiled, eyes dilating as she launched herself into her friend's waiting arms, "Scorpia!"

"Wildcat! Oh I missed you so much!"

"How did you..?"

"Melog led me to the cabin Princess Glimmer and Bow were trapped in after Prime took Glimmer from the boutique."

"The boutique?" Catra turned to Glimmer.

"After I escaped the first time I went there hoping to find you because I was denied access to the palace. Since someone was being me. Nice dress by the way." Glimmer giggled.

Catra blushed, "Hey, I made the thing!" She teased, "But seriously, how do you wear so many layers all the time?"

"Well, I'm not usually escaping burning buildings or breaking into my own home."

"Fair enough," Catra laughed. She glanced down when saw Melog purring against her, "You're such a good baby," She cooed, lifting them up and kissing their head before giving them little scratches behind their ears. They meowed happily.

"Catra?! Scorpia!"

The familiar voice made everyone tense and turn as Shadow Weaver approached, "What are you doing here?!"

"Uh- what are you doing here?" Glimmer asked, crossing her arms.

"I was attending the wedding before all of the dramatics occurred, Your Highness." She responded simply before turning back to her seamstresses, "You two are coming with me, you have a lot of work to catch up on. And you!" She glared at Catra, "Have been gone for far too long, you'll be lucky if I-"

"-If you, what, Ms. Weaver?" Bow asked, approaching with the twins and stepping between Catra and her employer, "I've seen what you've done to her, and I can promise that it will never happen again."

"What are you talking about, Bow?" Glimmer asked, eyebrows furrowing in concern.

"When she first arrived here I found her back covered in lash wounds. Fresh ones."

Catra looked away, ears pinning to her head.

"She is indebted to me, therefore anything that happens to her-"

"-Is your responsibility." Adora finished, venom in her voice and a glare so livid on her face that her brother recoiled in fear. She wrapped an arm around Catra when she noticed she was shaking.

"And as far as her debts go, I'll have the rest of it sent to you by the end of the week. She's not working for you anymore." Glimmer added, much to the shock of Shadow Weaver.

"What- why would you care about some random seamstress?"

"She's not just some random seamstress." Adora cut in, "I actually intend to make her my wife… If she would have me.."

Shadow Weaver was now flabbergasted, "What?!"

Catra gasped, looking up at the blonde, "M-Me? What about-..the arrangement?"

Adora nodded, turning to a very panicked looking Queen Angella, "I am still happy to unite our kingdoms, only through Catra instead. That would make her a princess, and it will also allow Glimmer the marriage she wants."

Glimmer's eyes widened, and she laughed, a small squeal escaping when the tutor pulled her into his arms.

"This is ridiculous! I won't allow-"

"What authority do you have to stop the arrangement?" Adam challenged, stepping in front of his sister and her chosen.

"Well- she's my-"

"Like I said, you'll get your money, therefore, you have no authority over her anymore." Glimmer repeated, "Now you can get off the castle grounds before I have you arrested for abusive acts against royalty."

Catra blushed at that. She couldn't believe any of this was actually happening. Just an hour ago she was terrified of execution.

Unable to say more, Shadow Weaver stormed off, wisely choosing to bite her tongue.

Angella approached Glimmer, placing a gentle hand on her shoulder, "I'm so proud of you."

"Thanks, mom…" Glimmer smiled, tears welling up once again.

"Truly, you're so strong and brave, much like your father. I'm so happy you can have the wedding you want."

"About that-" Catra gently cut in, "I'm so sorry about the whole.. impersonating thing. Bow and I were just trying to keep the engagement going while he looked for her."

"It's alright, though I must ask, why didn't you just come to me in the first place, Bow?"

The tutor felt his cheeks color, "I…well…"

"I'm here! I'm so sorry- you will not believe what I had to-" Castaspella stopped when she stumbled on the scene in front of her, "Oh. I see you've- sorted it all out. Good!"

"Ooh. Now things make sense." Angella rolled her eyes, smiling.

"Well, before we do anything regarding weddings or talking about what happened in more detail, I need a bath. It's been over a week and I am miserable!" Glimmer exclaimed, drawing a laugh out of the others.

⚔

"Catra?"

The magicat, now back in her own dress, turned from her spot on the balcony to face Adora, "Yes?"

"I was hoping to return this to you.." The blonde blushed as she stepped up to Catra, presenting the ring from the night before.

A smile slowly formed on Catra's face, "Are you sure..? You thought I was Glimmer the whole time, how-" Her breath hitched when Adora gently cupped her cheek, guiding their gazes to meet.

"You only looked like her, everything you said about yourself and did was still you. There's no doubt in my mind, I want you as my wife. Will you have me?'

"Yes..! Of course I will," Catra sniffed, waiting until the ring was on her finger before wrapping her arms around Adora in a hug, "... I love you, Adora."

"I love you too, Catra, my beautiful princess and wife to be."

Chapter End Notes

The intensity of this chapter is so insane to me, so much just happened! I hope you're satisfied with Shadow Weaver's public shaming! Haha, it was very satisfying to me.

Comments and Kudos make my week! I love hearing what you think about the story and what you think will happen next! (Or in this case, the ending!) <3

Chapter 10: Written in Your Heart

Chapter Notes

I am so sorry, I meant to post this little epilogue a while ago but I got busy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Glimmer couldn't stop the snicker that escaped when she stepped into her room. Catra was standing awkwardly on a platform while her wedding dress was adjusted by surrounding servants, "How are you doing?"

"Uh- fine?" Catra blushed, "I never thought I'd be in a wedding dress..marrying a princess no less."

“You deserve it, especially after everything you did for me and all you've been through.”

“I guess..” Catra sighed in relief when the maids and tailors finally stepped away, allowing her to step down from the platform and approach Glimmer, “I'm glad you get to marry Bow.”

“It's crazy that what happened is probably the only way it could have happened..”

“.. What's gonna happen to Prime?”

“Execution. He murdered my father and tried to do the same to me. But we'll deal with it after our honeymoons.”

Smiling, Catra nodded, “Absolutely.. We should get to the courtyard, huh?”

“Yeah.”

Giggling, the girls walked out of the room together, making their way downstairs.

“You know, in all my wildest dreams and wishes, this isn't anywhere in the scope of what I thought my reality could be.”

“What did you imagine?”

“Freedom. A small cottage in town with a kit of my own. Adoption. There's- so many kids that have no home.”

“Well, for the record, I think that's a beautiful wish. And you could still make it a reality.”

“Awfully big cottage,” Catra joked, drawing a giggle from Glimmer, “But yeah, I think so too.”

The duo stepped up to the doors of the courtyard, sharing nervously excited looks.

“Ready?”

“As I'll ever be.”

As the doors opened, the brides to be walked the aisle, surrounded by friends, and the loves of their lives waiting for them, both in tears and smiling at their partners with pure adoration.

The Princess finally got to choose what she wanted, and love who she wished.

The Pauper got her freedom, and a love she thought she could only dream of.

They both got each other, a lifelong friendship to be rivaled. Truly, nothing or nobody could match the beautiful Fate of the princess and the pauper.

Chapter End Notes

[And Shadow Weaver lost her business, and her home. Luckily, newly crowned princess Catra gave her a job at the Eternian Palace as a seamstress] :)

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